

AFIT Events & Special Notes

AFIT Keynote and Reception at Pavilion VI

Thursday 4:30 pm – 7:00 pm

*The Fascist Playbook and the Struggle to Legitimize **Crony** Capitalism after Neoliberalism*

- Barbara Hopkins

Student Paper Competition at Enchantment E

Friday 4:30 pm – 6:00 pm

- Anjalee Wanduragala, The Levy Institute at Bard College, NY, USA

- Luiza Santos, Federal University of Paraná, Brazil

- Theodoro Sposito, Federal University of Paraná, Brazil

Special Note on AFIT-05

It would be beneficial to your participation, and for the session in general, to have downloaded the software - Vensim - and installed it beforehand. You can do that at this link: <https://vensim.com/free-downloads/> . This version of the software is free for educational use.

WSSA Events

Coffee at Pavilion Court

8:00 am- 9:30 am on Thursday, Friday, and Saturday

1:30pm- 3:00 pm on Thursday and Friday

WSSA Opening Reception at Pavilion VI

Wednesday 6:00 pm – 8:00 pm

WSSA Gives Back Breakfast at Pavilion VI

Thursday 8:00 am – 9:30 am

WSSA President's Reception at Pavilion VI

Saturday 6:00 pm – 8:00 pm

Thursday 03/26/26

8:00 am - 9:30 am

Coffee Break

Location: Pavilion Court

AFIT-01 - Policy Challenges facing the USA Today

Location: Enchantment E

Chairperson: L. Randall Wray, Levy Institute

Climate Change and the US Homeowners' Insurance Market

- Dr. Alla Semenova, St. Mary's College of Maryland

Artificial Intelligence: Friend, Foe, Fraud

- Dr. L. Randall Wray, PhD, Levy Institute

Democratic Decay in the Modern World

- Dr. Nicola Matthews, Cal Poly Humboldt

*REVERSING THE PROLETARIANIZATION OF AMERICAN WORKERS AND ITS NEGATIVE
POLITICAL AND CULTURAL CONSEQUENCES*

- Dr. Jon D Wisman, Department of Economics, American University

LASC-02/ASE - Comportamiento económico e impacto de las políticas públicas en el bienestar humano / Economic behavior and policies impact on human well-being

Location: Fiesta 2

Chairperson: Humberto de Luna López, Universidad Autónoma de Zacatecas, México

*Regrading the Future: A Humanistic, Real-Time, Gamified Alternative to Traditional School
Grading in Mexico*

- Dr. Edgar Raúl Ramírez Zárate, Universidad de Guadalajara

- Luz Elva Zarate Sevilla, Universidad de Guadalajara

- Sebastián Ramírez Zárate, Universidad de Guadalajara

*Psychological traits and socio-labor competences. Case study: Managerial and
accountant sciences students*

- Fernando Pedro Viacava-Breiding, Prof., Tecnológico Nacional de México campus Morelia

- Jesús Ruiz-Flores, Universidad de Guadalajara (Retired) México

El traspasamiento como espacio de empoderamiento de mujeres rurales en comunidades seleccionadas de Zacatecas

- Dr. Humberto de Luna, Universidad Autónoma de Zacatecas
- Marisol Cruz Cruz, Universidad Autónoma de Zacatecas

Flujos de remesas y su incidencia en la estructura socioeconómica de Zacatecas

- Mr. Elías Ulises Carmona-Vázquez, Universidad Autónoma de Zacatecas, Unidad Académica de Economía

9:45 am – 11:15 am

AFIT-02 - Inflation, Monetary Policy & Price Stability

Location: Enchantment E

Chairperson: Samuel Stockman, Levy Economics Institute

A Test of the Monopoly Money Model of Price Level Determination

- Dr. Sam Levey, Illinois College

The Role of Production Networks in Price Stability

- Mr. Samuel Stockman, Levy Economics Institute

Dollarization in Cambodia: An Institutionalist Perspective

- Mr. Vitou Put, Levy Institute at Bard College

Capital "Flows" as a Misleading Metaphor

- Dr. Oleksandr Valchysheh, Global Institute for Sustainable Prosperity

URPE-01 - Teaching Heterodox Economics in the AI Era

Location: Fiesta 4

Chairperson: Geoffrey Schneider, Bucknell University

A.I. and the History of Economic Thought: The Odd Couple to Reinvigorate Critical Thinking and Economic Education

- Dr. Oak McCoy, University of New England

Talking to dead economists: GPTs and HET pedagogy

- Dr. Rojhat Avsar, Columbia College Chicago

Teaching political economy in the era of artificial intelligence: Alternative writing assignments to promote critical thinking

- Dr. Geoffrey Schneider, Bucknell University

Universal Design and Artificial Intelligence: Building Engaged Introductory Courses

- Dr. Mila Malysheva, Skidmore College

11:30 am – 12:50 pm

AFIT-04 - Institutional Methods and Social Provisioning

Location: Enchantment E

Chairperson: Neal Wilson, Center for Economic Information – University of Missouri
Kansas City

Open Inquiry and Evaluation: The case of the economics of healthcare delivery

- Dr. Robert J Kemp, KempHE

An Institutional Health Economics

- Dr. Neal Willson, Center for Economic Information – University of Missouri Kansas City

*An Economic Analysis of Decision Making at Oregon Community Colleges, and Its
Consequences for the Quality of Higher Education*

- Dr. Kevin P. Furey, Chemeketa Community College

ASE-01 - Labor, Governance, and Inequality in Contemporary Capitalism

Location: Fiesta 4

Chairperson: Maria Clara Pedroza Santos, University of New Mexico

Discussant: Nara Chung, Colorado State University

Governance and Gains: How Financial Interests Shape the Durability of Firm Relationships

- Dr. Mohit Arora, Visiting Assistant Professor, Department of Economics, Union College,
Schenectady, NY 12308

Labor Market Deregulation and Death of Despair Evidence from Advanced Economies

- Mr. Nara Chung, Colorado State University

Formalization and Labor Market Adjustment after Brazil's Domestic Worker Reform

- Maria Clara Pedroza Santos, University of New Mexico

1:00 pm – 2:30 pm

Coffee Break 1:30 pm – 3:00 pm

Location: Pavilion Court

AFIT-03 - Property, Housing & Institutional Boundaries

Location: Enchantment E

Chairperson: James I. Sturgeon, University of Missouri-Kansas City

Property in the 21st Century

- Ms. Nadege Ngomsi, University of Missouri Kansas City

Housing and the Price Mechanism: Policy Failures and Alternatives in the Provisioning of Homes

- Dr. Erik Dean, Portland Community College
- Suzy Deuster, City Council, Portland Oregon

The Tenant's Right to Complain: Code Violation Calls and Landlord Retaliation in Kansas City, Missouri

- Dr. Ely Melchior Fair, Knox College

Why is not Intangible Property Common Property

- Dr. James Sturgeon, University of Missouri-Kansas City

URPE-02 - Uneven development: Contemporary experiences

Location: Fiesta 4

Chairperson: Geoffrey Schneider, Bucknell University

Assam and its Development

- Mr. Kabeer Bora, University of Missouri - Kansas City

Peripheralizing the Service Economy: Digital Platforms and the Virtual Mobility Fix

- Mr. Zachary Sedefian, Brooklyn College, Political Science Department

World Hegemony and the Evolution of Currency Orders

- Mr. Patrick A Hallan, University of Utah

ASE-02 - Crisis, Institutions, and Self-Organization Beyond Capitalism

Location: Pavilion II

Chairperson: Jeremy Garrison, Colorado State University

[HYBRID] Veblen and Post-Keynesians: How Can the Crisis Truly Act as a Trigger to Self-Organise a New Resilient System of Energy Community?

- Mu-Jeong Kho, University College London (UCL), UK

The Social and Cultural Effects of Markets and Capitalism: Evidence from Folklore and Ethnography

- Mr. Jeremy Garrison, Colorado State University

LASC-04/ASE - Reconfiguration of Global Value Chains, Geoeconomics and Climate Change / Reconfiguración de Cadenas Globales de Valor, geoeconomía y cambio climático

Location: Fiesta 1

Chairperson: Rafael Antonio Díaz-Porras, Universidad Nacional de Costa Rica

Discussant: Yolanda Carbajal-Suárez, Universidad Autónoma del Estado de México

Educación financiera en cadenas agroalimentarias locales frente a la reconfiguración de las cadenas globales de valor

- Dr. Sara Elvira Galbán-Lozano, Universidad Panamericana
- Marisol Velázquez-Salazar, Universidad Panamericana

Reconfiguración de las cadenas globales de valor del café en México: trabajo, ética y sostenibilidad desde una perspectiva humanista

- Dr. Marisol Velazquez-Salazar, Universidad Panamericana
- Julio César Galindo López, Universidad Panamericana

Percepciones de productores de café de la Zona de Los Santos, Costa Rica, con respecto al cambio climático.

- Dr. Gerardo Jiménez- Porras, Universidad Nacional, Costa Rica

2:45 pm – 4:15 pm

AFIT-05 - Teaching Curves and Learning Curves: A System Dynamics Workshop on Early Literacy Inequality

Location: Enchantment E

A System Dynamics Model of the Black-White Reading Gap

- Dr. Linwood Tauheed, University of Missouri Kansas City

This interactive professional development session guides participants in building a system dynamics model of kindergarten letter-recognition disparities, showing how differences in teacher expectations tied to race and class can generate Black–White proficiency gaps even when student learning processes are modeled as race-neutral. Participants will work with free simulation software and provided data while exploring innovative methods for linking teacher instruction, learning-forgetting dynamics, and ECLS-K trend data.

URPE-03 - Political economy of class, crises, precarity and education

Location: Pavillion II

Chairperson: Geoffrey Schneider, Bucknell University

The impossible possibility of “class culture”: thinking through the legacy of the recognition/redistribution debate for American politics today

- Dr. Ellen Cox, Transylvania University

[HYBRID] Veblen and Polanyi on Radical Economic Philosophy (Retrospect and Prospect):
How Can Crisis Truly Act as a Trigger to Self-Organise New Resilient Systems of Community?

- Mu-Jeong Kho, University College London (UCL), UK

A model of nature-dependency, labor empowerment, and precarity

- Dr. Alfredo Rosete, Economics Central Connecticut State University

Veblen’s Higher Learning in America and an Assessment of Economics Education in American Colleges and Universities

- Dr. Hamid Azari-Rad, Ph.D., State University of New York–New Paltz

4:30 pm – 7:00 pm

AFIT Keynote and Reception

Location: Pavilion VI

The Fascist Playbook and the Struggle to Legitimize Crony Capitalism after Neoliberalism

- Barbara Hopkins

Friday 03/27/26

8:00 am – 9:30 am

Coffee Break

Location: Pavilion Court

WSSA Gives Back Breakfast

Location: Pavilion VI

AFIT-06 - Reclaiming Original Institutional Economics: From Meta-Theory to Practice

Location: Enchantment E

An ReEvolution in Original institutional Economics

- Dr. Linwood Tauheed, University of Missouri Kansas City

This workshop examines the limited influence of Original Institutional Economics since the New Deal and argues for reviving its relevance to human well-being in the face of New Institutionalism's dominance. Moving from meta-theory to theory to practice, it introduces a critical institutional framework, theory-building methods, and applied examples in education, family life, and community development.

AFIT-11 - Financialization, Technology, and Institutional Evolution

Location: Enchantment F

Chairperson: Rojhat Avsar, Columbia College

Financialization of Technology Companies and Financial Technology

- Ms. Emilia G Cooper, Levy Economics Institute

Neural Networks, Intelligibility, and Semantic Reconstruction

- Dr. Rojhat Avsar, Columbia College Chicago

The Geometry of Institutions: Networks, Corruption, and the Commons

- Dr. Rafed Amin Al-Huq, Tulane University

Transformational Growth and Techno-Institutional Regimes

- Christopher Watkins, University of Missouri–Kansas City

9:45 am -11:15 am

AFIT-08 - Technology, Finance, and Institutional Construction

Location: Enchantment E

Chairperson: Devin Rafferty, Saint Peters University

The Origin and Evolution of the Normal Probability Distribution as an Institution within Financial Economics

- Dr. Devin Thomas Rafferty, Saint Peter's University

Economics in the Age of an Information Swirl

- Mr. Thomas Stark, MS BS BA, Permian Basin Industrial Services LLC

Cryptocurrency: From Ceremonial Spectacle to Instrumental Use

- Mr. Shane Wray, Levy Economics Institute

How the Digital Economy Underwrites Biopolitics: From Crimmigration to Palantir

- Dr. Karol Gil Vasquez, Nichols College/ Boston University

[LASC-09/ASE - Políticas económicas y comerciales: inequidades sociales y crisis](#)

Location: Fiesta 1

Chairperson: Hugo Acosta-Martínez, Investigador Independiente

[HYBRID] Misery index and income inequality in Latin America, 2014-2024

- Mrs. Reyna Vergara González, Universidad Autónoma del Estado de México

- Yolanda Carbajal Suárez, Universidad Autónoma del Estado de México

Hasta que colapse. Estudio comparativo de dos desastres de agua

- Dr. Jose Nicolás Jimenez Escamilla, Maestro, Benemérita Universidad Autónoma de Puebla

El derecho humano al agua en Sinaloa, México: su acceso en las comunidades rurales de Mochicahui

- Dr. Maria Azucena Caro-Dueñas, Doctorado, Universidad Autónoma Indígena de México

- Elvira Martínez-Salomón, Universidad Autónoma Indígena de México

11:30 am -12:50 pm

[AFIT-07/EG - Modern Money Theory in Debate: Money, Credit, and the State](#)

Location: Enchantment E

Chairperson: Reynold F. Nesiba, Augustana University

Book Review Panel: Understanding Modern Money Theory: Money and Credit in Capitalist Economies, by L. Randall Wray

- Dr. Reynold F Nesiba, Augustana University

- Karol Gil-Vasquez, Nichols College & Boston University

- Liudmila Malyshava, Skidmore College

- William Waller, Hobart and William Smith Colleges

- L. Randall Wray, Levy Economics Institute of Bard College

1:00 pm -2:30 pm

[Coffee Break 1:30 pm – 3:00 pm](#)

Location: Pavilion Court

AFIT-09 - Grant Writing as Institutional Practice: Collaboration, Capacity, and the Research Commons

Location: Enchantment E

Grant Writing as Institutional Practice: Reclaiming the Knowledge Commons in an Era of Scarcity

- Dr. Larry D Wigger Jr, University of Missouri-Kansas City

2:45 pm – 4:15 pm

AFIT-10 - From Microfinance to Middle Class?

Location: Enchantment E

Chairperson: Jack Reardon, International Journal of Pluralism and Economics Education

Roundtable Discussion of From Microfinance to Middle Class? How to Improve Female Entrepreneurship Programs in India and China

- Janice Peterson, California State University, Fresno
- Rojhat Avsar, Columbia College Chicago
- Aycha KatunWilliams, Rollins College
- Jack Reardon, International Journal of Pluralism and Economics Education
- Benjamin Wilson, State University of New York, Cortland
- Tonia Warnecke, Rollins College

4:30 pm - 6:00 pm

AFIT-17 – Student Paper Competition

Location: Enchantment E

Chairperson: Jenica Marie Kramer, UNAM

Double Othering, Remittances, and Institutional Power: The Sri Lankan Diaspora in the 2022 Aragalaya

- Anjalee Wandduragala, Levy Institute at Bard College, NY

Sharing, Caring, Surviving: Thorstein Veblen's Parental Bent and Human Evolution Beyond Violence

- Luiza Santos, Federal University of Paraná, Brazil

Was Alfred Eichner an Ayrisian at Heart? Recovering the 'Hidden' Institutional Foundations of Eichner's Economic Thought

- Theodoro Sposito, Federal University of Paraná, Brazil

Saturday 03/28/26

8:00 am – 9:30 am

Coffee Break

Location: Pavilion Court

AFIT-13 - Political Economy, Imperialism, and Sustainability

Location: Fiesta 1

Chairperson: John Battaile Hall, Portland State University

Exploring Imperialism in the Age of Neoliberalism (the late 1970s – Present): Key Practices and Progressive Alternatives

- Dr. Anna Klimina, PhD, University of Saskatchewan, Canada

Realizing an Alternative Political Economy of Sustainability: The Contributions of Radical Ecology and Heterodox Economics (edited by Arturo Hermann, Routledge)

- Arturo Hermann, BA Hons, MA, MBA, Italian National Institute of Statistics (Istat)

Thorstein Veblen, the Vested Interests, and the Transition to 'Technofeudalism'

- Dr. John Battaile Hall, Ph.D., Department of Economics, Portland State University

An Evolutionary Approach to the Racial Epistemicide in Economics

- Mr. André de Jesus Torres, PhD Candidate, World Political Economy, UFABC (Brazil)

11:30 am – 12:50 pm

AFIT-14 - Extraction, Institutions, and Historical Continuities

Location: Fiesta 1

Chairperson: David Seaton, University of Missouri Kansas City

Caste, Climate, and the Commons: Resource Scarcity as a Driver of Caste-Based Violence in India

- Atul Kumar, Colorado State University - Economics PhD Program

- Alex Hegg, Colorado State University - Economics PhD Program

The Political Economy of Beer and the Implications for Pedagogies of the Academic Resistance

- Mr. David Seaton, Esq., University of Missouri Kansas City Economics Department

Veblen(1923) 's Absentee Ownership: the case of America, after a century: The persistence of depredatory social features in America in a different framework

- ADRIAN DE LEON ARIAS, UNIVERSIDAD DE GUADALAJARA

1:00 pm - 2:30 pm

AFIT-15 - Commons, Distribution, and Resistance

Location: Fiesta 1

Chairperson: Matthew Rice, Rollins College

Ceremonial Processes of Distribution: Reframing Comparative Systems

- Dr. Barbara E Hopkins, AFIT

The Atlantic Slave Trade and the Arts of Resistance

- Mr. Paul Nasca, Colorado State University

Seed Funding: Soybean Production and Political Instability

- Matthew Clarke Rice, Rollins College

- Joseph Pool, Rollins College

2:45 pm – 4:15 pm

AFIT-16 – Institutions, Knowledge, and Social Provisioning

Location: Fiesta 1

Chairperson: Kevin Capehart, California State University, Fresno

Reclaiming Hazel Kyrk: A Radical Institutional Perspective on Consumption

- Felipe Almeida, Federal University of Parana
- Marindia Brites, Federal University of Parana
- Beliza Borba de Almeida, Federal University of Parana
- Solange Marin, Federal University of Santa Catarina

Economic Common Sense: Survey Evidence

- Dr. Kevin W Capehart, California State University, Fresno
- Ahmad A. Borazan, California State University, Fresno

What Do We mean when we talk about pluralism in John Rogers Commons economic theory?

- Dr. Sebastião Neto Ribeiro Guedes, São Paulo State University (Unesp), Brazil
- Rodrigo Constantino Jeronimo, São Paulo State University (Unesp), Brazil
- Celso Pereira Nêris Júnior, São Paulo State University (Unesp), Brazil

Mind the Surplus: A Case Study in Institutional Selection and Mental Health

- Mr. Ammar Mooraj, Levy Institute, Bard College

4:30 pm – 6:00 pm

AFIT-18 - Institutional Political Economy of Production, Care, and Power

Location: Fiesta 1

Chairperson: Oak McCoy, UNE

Institutional Evolution and the Art of Making Mezcal: A Veblenian Analysis of Power and Transformation in Oaxaca, 1994–Present

- Jenica Marie Kramer, UNAM

Applying the Veblenian Dichotomy to the Sraffian System of Production

- Theodore Raitzer, University of Missouri-Kansas City

Transforming the Social Infrastructure from Care to Control: Feminist and Institutional Perspectives on Austerity-Induced Public Goods Degradation

- Nejla Routsong, Colorado State University

6:00 pm – 8:00 pm

WSSA President's Reception

Location: Pavilion VI